

What I need from you, and from Psoola

The short companion to the backend plan of 27 September 2026. Everything below is a question, a decision, or something to hand over. Where I have a suggestion it is in the right-hand column — a simple “yes” is enough. Tick the box when it is done.

The one thing that decides the whole timeline: Psoola's test credentials. Registration can open on **27 October** only if they are in hand by **6 October**. Every week they are late, the opening slips a week. Please start that conversation tomorrow, not next week.

Now needed to start building **Before launch** needed before registration opens **Later** can wait until the site is live

1. From Psoola

	Item	When	Why it matters
☐	Their API documentation — the file or web page developers read	Now	Tells us how to create a payment, how the redirect works and what the webhook sends. Nothing on the payment side can be designed in detail without it.
☐	Test (sandbox) credentials , plus test cards or test wallets	Now	So we can make hundreds of fake payments while building, with no real money.
☐	How they secure the webhook — signature, shared secret, or a list of their addresses	Now	Otherwise anyone who guesses our webhook address could pretend a payment succeeded.
☐	Written confirmation that Visa, MasterCard, FIB and FastPay will all be live on our account, and by what date	Now	The payment step on the site will list exactly these four.
☐	What company documents they need for the merchant account	Now	Usually the slowest part with any payment company. Start the paperwork immediately.
☐	Their fees , the minimum and maximum amount per payment, and the currency (IQD)	Before launch	Fees go into the ticket price. The maximum matters if a sponsor ever pays through them.

☐	Whether refunds can be done through the API, by request, or not at all	Before launch	Tickets are non-refundable, but a duplicate payment must be refundable.
☐	How and when the money is settled to the bank account, and a report we can download	Before launch	To check the admin's daily total against what actually arrived.
☐	Whether their payment page is available in Arabic and Kurdish	Before launch	Most visitors register in Arabic or Kurdish. If it is English-only, we warn them on the step before.
☐	Live credentials	Later	Only when we go live. They go into one file on the server — never in an email, a chat or the website files.

2. Decisions — a “yes” is enough

	Question	When	My suggestion
☐	Domain name	Now	ismile.krd if available (the site already uses info@ismile.krd). Otherwise ismile.iq or ismile-summit.com. Buy for two years, auto-renew on.
☐	Hosting: A — managed hosting with cPanel, or B — a VPS	Now	A. PHP, MySQL, email, SSL and backups come ready; nobody has to maintain Linux. Pick B only if someone on the team will look after a server.
☐	Students: approve the ID photo <i>before</i> they pay, or let them pay first and refund if rejected?	Now	Approve first. Student registers → you approve (usually the same day) → they get the “Pay now” email → they pay → ticket. Professionals pay immediately. This avoids most refunds.
☐	Do you need age and gender on the form?	Before launch	If they are not used for anything, remove them. Less data, less risk.
☐	Email sending service	Before launch	Brevo — simple, free tier covers testing, tickets sent from tickets@ismile.krd. Not a personal Gmail.
☐	Refund wording for the form and the ticket email	Before launch	“Tickets are non-refundable. Duplicate payments are refunded.”

☐	Privacy notice and student consent wording	Before launch	I draft it in English, Arabic and Kurdish; you approve.
☐	May a sponsor ever pay through Psoola, or always by bank transfer?	Later	Bank transfer, unless Psoola's maximum clearly allows the amounts.
☐	A one-day external security test before launch (a few hundred dollars)?	Later	Recommended for something this sensitive. Not required to build.

3. Numbers and names

	Item	When	Your answer
☐	Professional ticket price (IQD)	Before launch	_____
☐	Student ticket price (IQD)	Before launch	_____
☐	Lunch price, Day 1 and Day 2 (IQD)	Before launch	_____
☐	Ticket capacity — the most people the venue can take	Before launch	_____
☐	Lunch capacity per day — from the caterer	Before launch	_____
☐	Booth spots per sponsor tier (Diamond / Platinum / Gold / Silver)	Before launch	_____
☐	Office phone for workshop bookings (the site still says “Will be announced soon”)	Before launch	_____
☐	Who reviews student IDs (one person plus a backup)	Before launch	_____
☐	Who handles sponsor and booth requests	Before launch	_____
☐	Who is on call during registration and on the summit days	Before launch	_____
☐	Who holds the two-factor codes for the Owner and Finance accounts	Before launch	_____
☐	Who works the check-in desk (they get the scan-only login)	Later	_____

4. Once you have bought the domain and hosting

- ☐ The login for the **hosting control panel** and for the **domain registrar**. Send them privately (a password manager share, or written down and handed over) — **never in this chat**.

- ☐ Tell me whether the panel puts the site at the **domain root** or in a subfolder — it will show this.
- ☐ Confirm the plan includes: PHP 8.1 or newer, MySQL 8 / MariaDB 10.6+, free SSL, cron jobs, at least 10 GB, daily backups, SSH. If the order page does not say, ask their support before paying.
- ☐ Two email addresses on the domain: `info@` and `tickets@` (the panel creates them in a minute).

5. Two questions I have for you

	Question	Why I ask
☐	Timing. Are you happy with registration opening on 27 October ? Or is there a date the team has already announced?	The plan is built around 27 October. If an earlier date has been promised publicly, we need to know now — the only lever is Psoola's speed.
☐	Existing registrations. Has anyone already registered or paid by hand — by WhatsApp, bank transfer or phone — before the system exists?	If yes, I plan an import so they end up in the database with tickets like everyone else, instead of being handled separately at the door.

What does not wait for any of this: buying the domain and hosting, moving the website, and creating the database — week 1 of the plan — can start the moment the hosting exists. The Psoola items unblock weeks 3 onward.

Companion to *iSmile 2026 — Backend Plan (Psoola payments, tickets, database)*, 27 September 2026. Section numbers there: Psoola items → section 2; decisions → section 13; hosting → section 8; security roles → section 10.